DISCO (6146.T): Kuwabata plant tour: Confirmed initiatives to improve productivity to meet robust demand; reiterate Buy

Shuhei Nakamura
+81(3)4587-9932 | shuhei.nakamura@gs.com
Goldman Sachs Japan Co., Ltd.

Kaho Otake
+81(3)4587-7498 | kaho.otake@gs.com
Goldman Sachs Japan Co., Ltd.

On October 9, we attended a company-hosted tour of the Kuwabata Plant at Disco's Hiroshima Works, its main production base. The event was organized for sell-side analysts. We summarize our key takeaways below. There were no updates on current market conditions or capacity utilization rates. However, our is impression is that initiatives to boost per-capita productivity are being implemented throughout (which may be effectively increasing production capacity), including efforts to promote automation and in-house production in manufacturing processes for core equipment and consumables, and the development of a multi-skilled workforce. We continue to expect shipment momentum to ratchet higher from 3Q onward, driven by benefits from OSAT advanced packaging investment and various technological changes, including EMIB-T, hybrid bonding, and co-packaged optics (CPO). We reiterate our Buy rating.

Automation initiatives

As part of its initiatives to enhance productivity, the company is actively advancing automation across its production facilities. For example, on the grinder manufacturing floor, an area of high activity, management has utilized overhead ceiling space to automate the transport of parts (previously done manually) using automated guided vehicles (AGVs). These have been installed in stages starting last year (all equipment is produced in-house). Furthermore, in the manufacturing process for grinding wheels (a grinder consumable), the bonding process between the aluminum core and the segments (the parts that make direct contact with the workpiece) has been partially automated (although the company noted there is still room for improvement in the productivity of the automated line). For processes that still rely on manual labor, the company is promoting multi-skilling across the workforce as much as possible to maximise per-capita productivity.

In-house production efforts

Initiatives to promote in-house production are underway across various processes on the manufacturing floor. In addition to the aforementioned AGVs that enable ceiling transport, Disco's in-house development initiatives cover everything from equipment used for wheel inspection and dimensional processing, equipment required in the manufacturing of blades (a dicer consumable), air bearings used in spindles (a core grinder component), and even the sheet metal processing machinery used to fabricate equipment parts. However, our impression is that there is still room to

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further advance in-house production, as certain processes still use externally purchased items or third-party equipment.

Thinking on parts procurement and inventory

Although the manufacturing floors remain very active responding to robust demand, there are currently no bottlenecks in parts procurement that would hinder production. As a medium-term initiative, rather than holding customized inventories of raw materials and parts, the company is focusing on stocking components as universal inventory that can easily adapt to specification changes, for example. The push to produce equipment used for parts processing, such as the sheet metal processing machines noted above, in-house is also part of this effort to enable stocking in the form of universal inventory.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Disco

Valuation methodology: Our 12-month target price of ¥105,000 is based on our FY3/28E EBITDA estimate, the global SPE sector average EV/EBITDA of 18X, and a sector-relative premium of 50% in view of Disco's high profitability (our TP implies FY3/28E P/E of 39X and P/B of 12X). We are Buy rated.

Key risks: Yen appreciation against the US dollar, slowdown in China demand or tightening of export controls, slowdown in AI-related demand, loss of market share, and deterioration in margins.

6146.T	12m Price Target: **¥105,000**	Price: **¥61,290**	Upside: **71.3%**

Buy

Market cap: ¥6.6tr / $42.0bn
Enterprise value: ¥6.3tr / $39.6bn
3m ADTV: ¥100.5bn / $631.3mn
Japan
Japan Semiconductor, SPE & Precision
M&A Rank: 3
Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: No

GS Forecast

	3/26	3/27E	3/28E	3/29E
Revenue (¥ bn)	436.9	598.7	772.6	918.0
Op. profit (¥ bn)	185.0	290.6	393.5	477.8
Op. profit CoE (¥ bn)	–	–	–	–
EPS (¥)	1,249.5	1,996.9	2,700.3	3,277.5
P/E (X)	37.9	30.7	22.7	18.7
P/B (X)	8.7	8.9	6.9	5.5
Dividend yield (%)	1.1	1.2	1.8	2.5
N debt/EBITDA (ex lease,X)	(1.4)	(1.2)	(1.2)	(1.4)
CROCI (%)	42.0	53.2	59.0	60.7

	6/26	9/26E	12/26E	3/27E
EPS (¥)	315.8	478.1	527.0	676.0

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 9 Oct 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

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Contributing Authors: Shuhei Nakamura Goldman Sachs Japan Co., Ltd., Kaho Otake Goldman Sachs Japan Co., Ltd..

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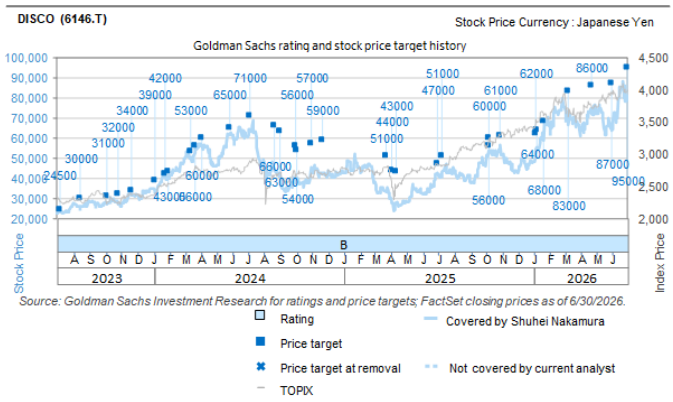
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Target price history table(s)

DISCO (6146.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
23-Aug-26	105,000	61,360
06-Jul-26	100,000	78,000
30-Jun-26	95,000	81,260
31-May-26	87,000	65,090
22-Apr-26	86,000	74,830
09-Mar-26	83,000	66,500
21-Jan-26	68,000	58,570
08-Jan-26	64,000	55,590
06-Jan-26	62,000	54,200
29-Oct-25	61,000	56,390
08-Oct-25	60,000	52,140
06-Oct-25	56,000	54,000
09-Jul-25	51,000	41,290
30-Jun-25	47,000	42,630
13-Apr-25	43,000	27,470
04-Apr-25	44,000	27,635
24-Mar-25	51,000	33,060
21-Nov-24	59,000	42,380
01-Nov-24	57,000	42,810
04-Oct-24	54,000	39,710
02-Oct-24	56,000	37,410
02-Sep-24	63,000	41,350
22-Aug-24	66,000	43,560
04-Jul-24	71,000	64,580
27-May-24	65,000	61,790
04-Apr-24	60,000	56,750
21-Mar-24	56,000	52,960
13-Mar-24	53,000	50,000
31-Jan-24	43,000	40,380
24-Jan-24	42,000	40,730
04-Jan-24	39,000	33,630
21-Nov-23	34,000	32,030
26-Oct-23	32,000	26,960

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